HOORVIA — GROUND MEAT INTERNAL TEMPERATURE CHART (BEEF, POULTRY, PORK & LAMB)

Quick Reference Cheat Sheet • 160°F Red Meat vs 165°F Ground Poultry • Burgers, Meatloaf & Tacos • US Letter (8.5" × 11")

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■ USDA SAFE INTERNAL TEMPERATURES BY GROUND MEAT SPECIES

Ground Meat Type	Pull From Heat At	Final Rested Temp (USDA)	Rest Time	Critical Safety & Moisture Note
Ground Beef (80/20, 85/15, 90/10)	156°F–158°F / 69°C	160°F / 71°C	3–4 min	Eliminates E. coli O157:H7; juices run clear
Ground Pork & Fresh Pork Sausage	156°F–158°F / 69°C	160°F / 71°C	3–4 min	Keep fat content ≥20% for juicy patties
Ground Lamb (Kofta / Gyro / Burgers)	156°F–158°F / 69°C	160°F / 71°C	4 min	Pair with grated onion or yogurt to retain moisture
Ground Bison / Venison / Wild Game	155°F–157°F / 68°C	160°F / 71°C	4 min	Ultra-lean (90/10); pull right at 157°F so it doesn't dry
Ground Chicken (Breast or Thigh Grind)	162°F / 72°C	165°F / 74°C (Mandatory)	3–4 min	93/7 thigh grind stays much juicier than 99% breast
Ground Turkey (85/15 or 93/7)	162°F / 72°C	165°F / 74°C (Mandatory)	3–4 min	Mix 1 tbsp olive oil or mayo per lb to prevent dryness

■ COOKING TIMING & PROBE GUIDE BY DISH FORMAT (BURGER, MEATLOAF, BALLS)

Ground Meat Dish	Cooking Temp	Avg Cook Time	Pull Temp	Exact Thermometer Probe Method
Smash Burger Patty (2.5–3 oz, 1/4")	450°F Griddle	2 min side 1 + 1 min side 2	160°F	Too thin for probe; cook until lacy brown & juices clear
Standard Burger Patty (4–5 oz, 3/4")	400°F Grill/Pan	4–5 min per side	157°F (Rest 160°F)	Insert probe horizontally through side edge to center
Thick Pub Burger (6–8 oz, 1.25")	375°F Med-High	6–7 min per side	156°F (Rest 160°F)	Press thumb dimple in raw center so patty cooks flat
Classic Beef/Pork Meatloaf (2 lb Loaf)	350°F / 175°C Oven	55–65 minutes	155°F (Rest 160°F)	Insert diagonally into dead center of loaf; rest 15 min
Turkey / Chicken Meatloaf (2 lb Loaf)	350°F / 175°C Oven	50–60 minutes	161°F (Rest 165°F)	Glaze top during last 15 min to lock in steam
Italian Meatballs (1.5-inch diameter)	400°F / 200°C Oven	16–20 minutes	160°F (165°F Poultry)	Probe center of the largest meatball on middle tray
Stuffed Peppers / Cabbage Rolls	375°F / 190°C Oven	40–45 minutes	160°F / 165°F	If using raw rice/meat mix, center must hit 160°F+
Skillet Taco / Bolognese Crumbles	Med-High Skillet	7–9 minutes	165°F+ (All browned)	Simmer until zero pink remains & fat renders clear

■ LEAN-TO-FAT RATIO GUIDE FOR GROUND BEEF & POULTRY

Package Ratio	Lean % / Fat %	Best Culinary Application	Shrinkage & Texture Behaviour
73 / 27 or 75 / 25	73% Lean / 27% Fat	Smash burgers on flat-top griddle	High grease render; forms ultra-crisp lacy edges
80 / 20 (Chuck)	80% Lean / 20% Fat	Gold standard for grilled & pan burgers	Ideal balance of beef flavor, juiciness, and hold
85 / 15 (Round)	85% Lean / 15% Fat	Meatloaf, meatballs, Shepherd's pie	Less greasy pooling in baking dishes & casseroles
90 / 10 or 93 / 7 (Sirloin)	90%+ Lean / ≤10% Fat	Tacos, chili, sloppy joes, pasta sauces	Dries out as burgers unless pan-ade binder is added

CHEF'S PRO TIP: How to keep burgers cooked to a safe 160°F as juicy as a medium-rare steak: Gently mix a 'panade' (2 tablespoons of crushed Ritz crackers or panko soaked in 2 tablespoons of milk per pound of meat) OR 1 tablespoon of mayonnaise into the raw grind before shaping patties!
USDA SAFE MINIMUM INTERNAL TEMPS: All Poultry & Ground Poultry: 165°F (74°C) • Ground Beef/Pork/Lamb: 160°F (71°C) • Whole Pork, Beef & Fish: 145°F (63°C)

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